KULKA AI

# How a conceptual budget gets built

Five phases, from an estimator's answers to a budget a client can act on — and the two that aren't finished yet, marked plainly.

**Estimator**
Answers what only a person at Kulka can know about the job.

**AI**
Derives, blends, and ranges — never the only voice behind a number.

**Kulka**
Reviews, approves, and issues. Nothing ships without this step.

## W-100 Intake

~20 min

The estimator answers what only a person can know

Estimator · Live

1. **Pick the project and how deep to go.**
   A tier sets how many questions get asked; a fast pass for an early number, deeper tiers when more is known.
2. **Answer the fixed set of intake questions.**
   Unit count, stories, construction type, parking type, and the handful of gates — gas building, roof type, HVAC system — that actually change what gets priced.
3. **Confirm or correct what the tool already worked out.**
   Where a fact can be derived from another one already given — elevator stops from stories, for instance — the tool proposes it; the estimator just confirms or overrides it.

PRODUCES A dated project record — every answer, every gate, ready to price. `kulka-budget-questions`

## W-200 Engineer

seconds

The tool works out what a real engineer would, before one is ever on the job

AI · Building

1. **Size the real MEP and life-safety numbers.**
   Electrical service size off NEC load tables, insulation off IECC climate-zone tables, HVAC tonnage off a square-foot-per-ton rule, elevator type off travel distance, sprinkler system type off construction and stories.
2. **Show the math, not just the number.**
   Every derived value carries the code section or method behind it, so it reads as an engineering fact, not a guess dressed up as one.
3. **Only reach outside the building when nothing captured already answers it.**
   Two gates — emergency responder radio coverage, fire alarm notification type — genuinely turn on local code, not on anything the tool already knows.

**A jurisdiction lookup has to run first**
The AI judgment layer this leans on can only judge text it's handed — it has no lookup of its own. Until that retrieval step exists, those two gates fall back to asking the estimator outright.

PRODUCES A labeled set of engineering criteria, dated, sourced, ready to price against. `design criteria panel`

## W-300 Blend & range

seconds

Real cost data sets the price — nothing is priced on AI judgment alone

AI · Not started

1. **Pull every real comparable for this line.**
   Actual bought costs first, vetted benchmark budgets second, an AI signal last — and only ever one voice among real data, never alone.
2. **Tighten the range as real evidence grows.**
   More comparables narrow the spread and sharpen the range; few or noisy comparables keep it wide on purpose, not by accident.
3. **Flag every line's confidence, and name why.**
   High, medium, or low — driven by comparable count, spread, and kind — and the flag names the comparables behind it, so it's never a black box.

**A mis-tagged cost row must never become a benchmark**
A line that's really a takeoff helper or a duplicate is excluded before it can reach a benchmark. One that got through once already threw a real benchmark off by two orders of magnitude.

PRODUCES A ranged budget, line by line, every range showing its own confidence. `ROM engine`

**The range is set. Now a person checks it.**
Nothing reaches a client until someone at Kulka has reviewed what the tool assumed.

## W-400 Review

minutes

Nothing reaches a client until a person has looked at what changed

Kulka · Live

1. **Anything imported gets staged before it counts.**
   A new cost file sits in a holding queue first; nothing becomes a benchmark until someone approves it, so one bad import can't silently corrupt a live number.
2. **A held line gets a second look, by name.**
   A low-confidence or newly-changed line is flagged right on the budget itself, not buried in a log somewhere else.
3. **Every assumption is written in plain English, on the sheet.**
   If the tool assumed a rate, a system type, or a pricing driver, that assumption prints right there — not hidden inside the math.

**A repeat import is skipped, not blended**
Re-importing the same cost code doesn't yet blend with what's already there — it's skipped on purpose, until real blending logic exists, so a re-import can never quietly double a number.

PRODUCES An approved, defensible ranged budget, with its assumptions in writing. `ingestion gate`

## W-500 Issue

at closing

The budget goes out, and the real numbers come back to make the next one better

Kulka · Building

1. **Issue the budget against a real, named project.**
   The ROM is linked to the actual job it's for, not left floating on its own.
2. **Compare it against what the job actually cost, once it closes.**
   Award-to-final and award-to-bought-out gaps get measured, not guessed at.
3. **Feed that gap back into the tool's own stops.**
   The dial that tightens future ranges is built entirely from Kulka's own measured history — never a made-up fudge factor.

PRODUCES A closed loop — the next budget is provably better than the last. `closing comparison`

## One conceptual budget, hands-on hours

**16 hrs**
By hand, today

**3 hrs**
With the ROM tool

**This counts hands-on hours only.** It doesn't count the review step above, and it doesn't count the trust a new tool has to earn over its first several real jobs — both take longer than any single number here shows.

○ a decision is waiting · ○ hard stop — do not proceed

Small gray type under every step is the detail; the bold line alone tells the whole story. **W-100 – W-500**